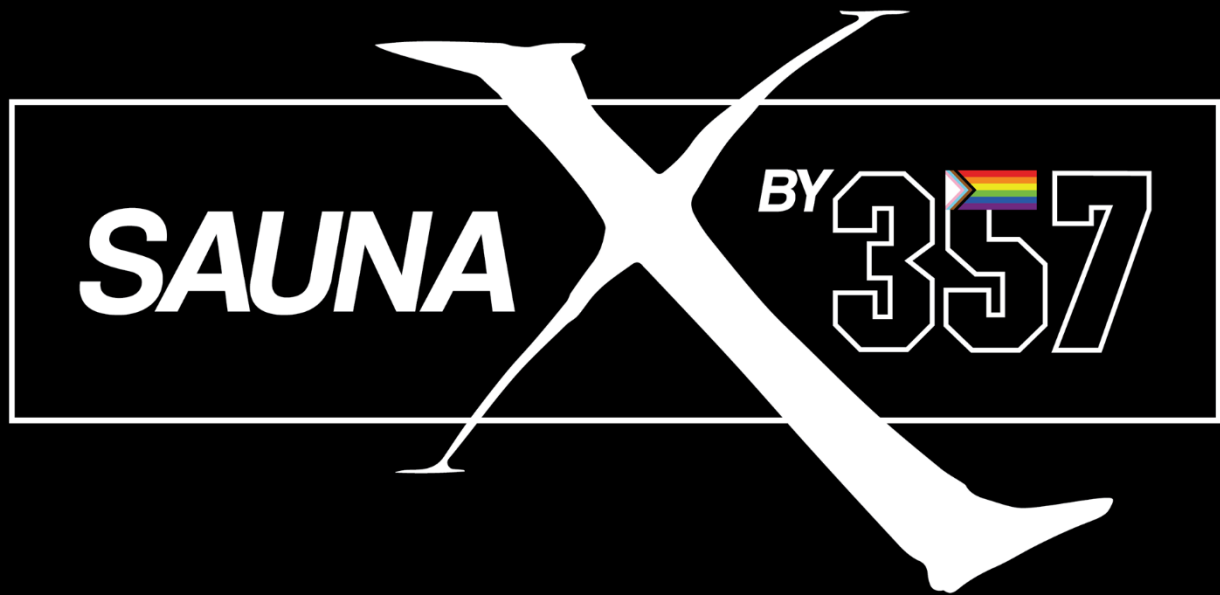




**Selling sex in the city:
is gay Sydney wanting more?**

PROJECT REVIEW REPORT

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If I am to critique my capstone business project in marketing, I would have to say that collecting primary data from an appropriate pool of people proved to be most challenging. I have now learned that, particularly for surveys of a personal nature that are more than a couple of questions long, it would be better to ask respondents in person rather than relying on the invited sample to actually answer the survey questions, either in full or just in part. My experience was that I received a lot of promises to complete the survey rather than actual responses I could use as part of my research.

This lacklustre response also led to me not having sufficient data to identify any patterns or relationships between independent and dependent variables; there were just not enough responses for any variables to stand out as statistically significant relative to the strength of any particular perceptions by customers, relative to the servicescape of Sauna X by 357.

While a situational analysis is easy to perform using Porter's Five Forces for industry considerations, PEST for macro external factors and SWOT for the business itself, finding the correct marketing theories and conceptual frameworks applicable to the business model of a sex on premises venue, selling sex as a service in an experience economy, required a comprehensive review of my previous studies in past university subjects.

I recalled what I had learned about buyer behaviour and how attitudes lead to actions, to explain the drivers of customer behaviour in sex on premises venues through Functional Attitude Theory and the theories that explain reasoned action and planned behaviour, due to an Experiential Hierarchy of Effects.

However, other than by using more generalised secondary data, the marketing theories rooted in environmental psychology about servicescapes could not be shown to apply to Sauna X by 357 and with an absence of any negative customer reviews found online, the conceptual frameworks around delivering service quality in the experience economy similarly could not be applied to the new sex on premises venue in practice.

With insufficient data to run through SPSS to find any correlations between variables or to run multiple regression calculations to understand the strength of any relationships, the recommendations could only be generalised to any new sex on premises venue. It would have been better to have known what was important to gay men in making their choice of venue vs the competition, rather than only relying on perceptual mapping and a few comments online to inform the recommendations made specifically for Sauna X by 357.

Some may think that is why I refer to the brand awareness tactics according to the Rossiter & Percy Advertising Grid but in sincerity, as one of the first frameworks that I found as actually informative and applicable in any marketing campaign, they are routinely referred to and included in a lot of my assessments, as I find them always insightful.

I have acknowledged the limitations of my research project in the report's conclusion, as well as making suggestions to how they could be countered in any future research. I admit that I failed to answer two of my research questions nor was I able to collect the minimum amount of primary data needed to meet two of my research objectives. But as a learning exercise and a demonstration of my ability to apply the knowledge I have learned throughout my Master of Marketing degree, as a process in the real world to a real business problem, I believe my research project and its report tick all the right boxes, at least those of the assessment rubric.